increase of finances are, in the code of princes, a choice form of . . . Divine worship'.

Besides, all the early Mughals had a near-obsessive interest in order and categorization, and Akbar's organizational bent of mind, as revealed in the *Ain-i-Akbari*, was as impressive as his physical courage. Abul Fazl records that Akbar had at least four categories of accountants and twelve of treasurers (nine for cash, three for gems and jewels). The heaps of ashrafis that Badauni describes were petty cash, 'gold and silver for the needy', who might 'have their wants relieved without delay'. In addition, Akbar's court also contained 1 crore of copper dams kept in coarse cloth bags holding 1000 dams each; and one amir who carried a 'purse' with 'a large sum of money' – presumably for sudden exigencies.[14]

Best known of Akbar's financial advisers was Todar Mal, a 'far-sighted and incorruptible man, who understood the secrets of administration',[15] as Abul Fazl describes him, and equally adept at war. More recently, a diwan of Munim Khan's, Shah Mansur, jobless after Munim's demise, had caught Akbar's eye and been appointed his vizier. In early September 1577, these two men were joined by Muzaffar Khan. Three years after he was expelled from the Patna expedition, two years after he was rewarded with Hajipur, and a year or so after Daud's perfumed head arrived in Fatehpur, Muzaffar Khan finally returned to Akbar's court, bringing a lavish tribute of 4 lakh rupees. Akbar welcomed the reformed grump and appointed him head of his administration, with Todar Mal and Shah Mansur as his deputies. This time around, Muzaffar Khan must have behaved himself, for an even greater increase in power would follow within eighteen months.

On 22 December 1578, just days after Khwaja Sultan returned from the Haj with his story of the miraculous rescue of the boy who fell overboard, Husain Quli died in the east. It does not appear as if Akbar regretted his demise, for all that Husain Quli had been an effective and uncomplaining general all these years. It may be that Husain Quli was tiring of doing his duty, or that he was impatient for more. According to Abul Fazl, he had even killed Daud's mother so that the loot he had seized from the Afghans 'might remain concealed'. It was twelve years since Akbar had galloped to Malwa to retrieve his due from Adham Khan, but clearly his commanders still liked to try and keep their earnings for themselves.